8.6.3 Mode – Grouped Frequency Distribution:

In case of a grouped frequency distribution, the exact values of the variables are not known and as such it is very difficult to locate mode accurately. In such cases, if the class intervals are of equal width, an appropriate value of the mode may be determined by

$$\text{Mode} = l + \left(\frac{f - f_1}{2f - f_1 - f_2} \right) \times c$$

The class interval with maximum frequency is called the modal class.

Where l - lower limit of the modal class; f - frequency of the modal class

f_1 - frequency of the class just preceding the modal class

f_2 - frequency of the class succeeding the modal class

c - width of the class interval

Example 8.17 Find the mode for the following data.

Marks	1-5	6-10	11-15	16-20	21-25
No. of students	7	10	16	32	24

Solution

Marks	f
0.5-5.5	7
5.5-10.5	10
10.5-15.5	16
15.5-20.5	32
20.5-25.5	24

Note

To convert discontinuous class interval into continuous class interval, 0.5 is to be substracted at the lower limit and 0.5 is to be added at the upper limit for each class interval.

Modal class is 16 -20 since it has the maximum frequency.

$l = 15.5, f = 32, f_1 = 16, f_2 = 24, c = 20.5 - 15.5 = 5$

$$\text{Mode} = l + \left(\frac{f - f_1}{2f - f_1 - f_2} \right) \times c$$

$$= 15.5 + \left(\frac{32 - 16}{64 - 16 - 24} \right) \times 5$$

$$= 15.5 + \left(\frac{16}{24} \right) \times 5 = 15.5 + 3.33 = 18.83.$$

8.6.4 An Empirical Relationship between Mean, Medan and Mode

We have seen that there is an approximate relation that holds among the three averages discussed earlier, when the frequencies are nearly symmetrically distributed.

$$\text{Mode} \simeq 3 \text{ Median} - 2 \text{ Mean}$$

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